

Sultant Of Oman
Ministry of Health
Royal Hospital



سلطنة عمان
وزارة الصحة
المستشفى السلطاني

Document Management System



Sultanate of Oman
Ministry of Health
The Royal Hospital
Department of Pharmacy

Code: PH-POL-11-Vers.1.2

Effective Date: 31/01/2024

Target Review Date: 31/01/2028

Title: Multidose Vials

Background

Use of multidose medications, increases the risk of medication contamination. This occurs when the products are shared between patients and during inappropriate handling and storage.

Purpose

The use of multidose medications should be avoided whenever possible as they are subject to contamination. The purpose of this policy is to avoid unintentional patient harm when using medications provided to patient care areas in multidose form.

Definitions

- Single use only injectable products are those which are:
 - medications in ampoules
 - powdered medications mixed on the nursing units
 - lack of antimicrobial preservative
 - vials labeled as single use only
 - vials used in emergency situations where aseptic technique may be in question
 - vials labeled by Pharmacy “Discard after use”
 - Intended for single patient for a single procedure
- Vials for multidose use are those which are:
 - Contain more than one dose of medication.
 - label indicates that it contains antimicrobial preservatives
 - vials labeled by Pharmacy “Single patient use item, Date opened ___, Discard after ___ days”

- Injectable medications shall be purchased as single-dose vials whenever possible to prevent transmission of infection.
- Multidose vials for multiple patients:
 - Must be labeled with a defined expiry date from the date of initial opening to ensure sterility of drug product.
 - Once opened, a multidose vial must be discarded after 28 days or manufacturers stated expiry, whichever is less.
 - Multidose vials used for multiple patients should be kept away from patient treatment area.
- Multidose vials for single patient:
 - Must be labeled with the patient name and discarded when the patient is discharged, the order has been discontinued or the designated expiry date has passed.
 - The label must include, patient's name, opening date and expiry date.
 - Vials should be kept near the patient treatment area during the treatment period.
 - Multidose vials are considered for a single patient if being used in immediate patient treatment area (e.g., OT, anesthesia, patient room or procedure carts).
 - Insulin pen must be labeled and must be given to the patient during discharge from the ward.
- When multidose vials are used, both the needle and syringe used to access the vials must be sterile.
- Vials which are considered multidose by the manufacturer, but do not have an auxiliary date label applied to the vial by pharmacy are to be treated as single-use vials.

Procedure

- Pharmacy
- Label all multidose vials with an appropriate auxiliary label which indicates defined time limit from initial opening and an area for date of opening to be recorded.
- Nursing staff/Medical staff
- Uses aseptic technique when opening injectable multidose products:
 - swab top of vial with alcohol and allow to dry prior to insertion of needle
 - uses new sterile needle and syringe each time vial is entered
 - completes date label attached to vial
 - attaches a patient label to the vial
 - stores all opened multidose vials at room temperature unless original vial was stored under refrigeration
 - contacts Pharmacy (9402, 9437, 9404) to verify latex content of rubber stoppers for latex allergy patients
- Discards multidose vial after the specified time from first opened, when the patient is discharged or the order for that medication is discontinued.

References

Title of book/ journal/ articles/ Website	Author	Year of publication
Injection Safety- Multidose vials	Centers for Disease Control and Prevention	2016

Checked By: Dr Zeena Al Maskari Ghalib Al Maawali Ph Asma Alhindi**Authorized by:** FAISAL AL-HARTHI**Review Details**

	Review BY	Review Date
1	Ghalib Al Mawaaly	05/09/2019

[Back](#)

© Copyright 2018 reserved 'Royal Hospital-
Information Technology Department'